OR NURSE CIRCULATOR CHECKLIST

WHO Surgical Safety Checklist · JCAHO Universal Protocol · AORN Perioperative Standards

PHASE 1 — SIGN IN & TIME OUT

Complete before patient enters OR & before first incision

PATIENT: _____ DOB: _____ MR#: _____ ROOM: _____ DATE: _____ CASE#: _____ SURGEON: _____ DX: _____

ANESTHESIA: _____ ⚠ ALLERGIES _____

1 PRE-OP VERIFICATION — WHO SIGN IN

- ☐ Consent: Surgical
- ☐ Consent: Blood Products
- ☐ Site Marking Verified
- ☐ Advance Directives Reviewed
- ☐ IV Access Confirmed
- ☐ Pulse Oximetry Applied & Reading
- ☐ Consent: Anesthesia
- ☐ Consent: Implant / Device
- ☐ History & Physical Present
- ☐ NPO Status Confirmed
- ☐ Patient Wristband ID Verified
- ☐ Medical Records Reviewed

WHO SIGN-IN CHECKLIST

Patient identity confirmed · Site marked before entering OR · Consent verified · Allergies reviewed · NPO confirmed

NPO TIME: CODE STATUS: _____

2 SAFETY VERIFICATION — WHO TIME OUT

- ☐ Fire Risk Assessment (B.I.D.)
- ☐ DVT Prophylaxis Timed / Given
- ☐ VTE Risk Assessed & Documented
- ☐ Airway / Aspiration Risk Reviewed
- ☐ Latex Allergy Protocol Initiated
- ☐ Antibiotic Prophylaxis Administered
- ☐ Fall Risk Identified & Flagged
- ☐ Patient Positioning Confirmed

WHO TIME-OUT CHECKLIST

Patient · Procedure · Site / Laterality · Positioning · Allergies · Sterility · Equipment · Implants confirmed

ANTIBIOTIC: _____ TIME: _____

TOURNIQUET: _____

ASA CLASSIFICATION (CIRCLE):

I / II / III / IV / V / VI

3 INSTRUMENT & SPONGE COUNT

COUNT PHASE	INSTRUMENTS	SPONGES	NEEDLES	BLADES	OTHER
Pre-Procedure					
Closing (Fascia)					
Closing (Skin)					
Final Count					

⚠ COUNT DISCREPANCY PROTOCOL

1. Notify surgeon immediately · 2. DO NOT close · 3. Manual sweep · 4. X-ray · 5. Document fully

ADD-ON INSTRUMENTS / EXTRAS:

4 INTRA-OP TRACKING — REAL-TIME DOCUMENTATION

PATIENT POSITIONING (CIRCLE):

Supine / Prone / Lateral L / Lateral R / Trendelenburg / Reverse Trend. / Beach Chair / Lithotomy / Fracture Table / Other: _____

URINE OUTPUT (CC): EBL (CC):

CRYSTALLOID (CC): BLOOD LOSS (CC): BLOOD TRANSFUSED (CC): NET I/O (CC):

- ☐ Specimens Collected
- ☐ Cautery Unit Tested
- ☐ Implants Documented
- ☐ Tourniquet Inflated / Deflated
- ☐ Grounding Pad Placed
- ☐ Pressure Points Protected

SURGEON PREFERENCES / OPERATIVE NOTES:

4B WOUND CLASSIFICATION (WHO)

WOUND CLASS PER WHO:

INTRA-OP QUICK STATS

FOLEY: DRAINS:

DRESS: COMPRESS:

RN NOTES / INTRA-OP EVENTS:

OR CIRCULATOR CHECKLIST — SITE MARKING & HANDOFF

Anatomical Site Marking · Specimen Management · Post-Op Sign-Out · SBAR PACU Handoff

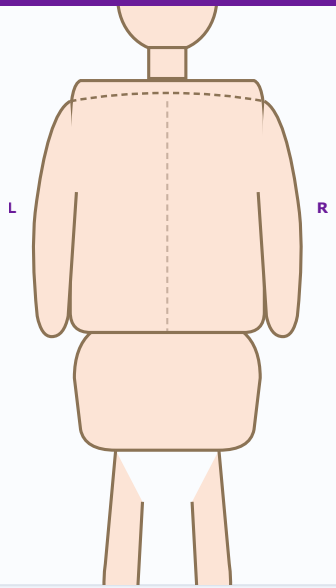
PHASE 2 — SIGN OUT & HANDOFF

Complete at case conclusion before patient leaves OR

PATIENT: _____ DOB: _____ MR#: _____ ROOM: _____ CASE#: _____ SURGEON: _____ PROCEDURE: _____

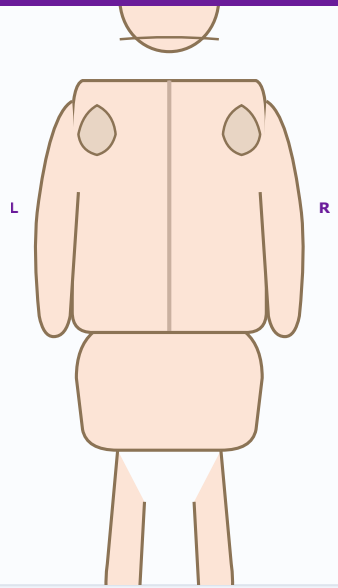
⚠ ALLERGIES _____

ANTERIOR VIEW (FRONT)



Mark L / R with incision type — circle site & arrow indicating direction

POSTERIOR VIEW (BACK)



Indicate posterior incision location with arrow and label

5 SPECIMEN MANAGEMENT

1. ID Label: _____ Loc: _____
2. ID Label: _____ Loc: _____
3. ID Label: _____ Loc: _____
4. ID Label: _____ Loc: _____

PATHOLOGY / CULTURE REQ. (CIRCLE): YES / NO

SPECIMEN NOTES / CLINICAL HISTORY:

- ☐ Labeled Correctly
- ☐ Placed in Formalin
- ☐ Given to RN / Sent
- ☐ Culture Tubes Labeled
- ☐ Handed Off to PACU
- ☐ Log Book Signed

6 POST-OP SIGN-OUT

WHO SIGN OUT

PROC TIME: _____ SURGEON: _____

EST. BLOOD LOSS: _____

- ☐ Counts Correct
- ☐ Specimens Labeled
- ☐ Implants Confirmed
- ☐ Dressing Applied
- ☐ Drains Output Recorded
- ☐ Urine Output Recorded
- ☐ Final Sponge Count Done
- ☐ Equipment Returned
- ☐ Tourniquet Deflated
- ☐ Grounding Pad Removed

POST-OP ORDERS / PACU REPORT:

7 SBAR PACU HANDOFF

S — SITUATION

B — BACKGROUND

A — ASSESSMENT

R — RECOMMENDATION

CIRCULATING RN: _____ RN SIGNATURE: _____ TIME: _____ PACU RN: _____ PACU RN SIGNATURE: _____